Sales Playbook

Owning area: Sales

Last reviewed: August 2026

Document owner: Director of Sales Operations

Policy reference: SAL-PLB-001

Applies to: IronStore commercial teams in the European Economic Area and United Kingdom

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1. Purpose and Overview

This playbook defines the standard sales approach for IronStore’s consumer-product business. It provides a common operating model for acquiring, qualifying, converting, and retaining customers across electronics, home essentials, clothing, outdoor equipment, beauty, and related categories.

IronStore primarily serves consumers through its online storefronts and mobile channels. Sales activity must support profitable growth, accurate customer communication, compliant data handling, and a consistent customer experience across markets.

The playbook applies to direct sales activity, marketplace opportunities, affiliate partnerships, business-to-business enquiries, and promotional campaigns managed by Sales or in partnership with Marketing, Merchandising, and Customer Operations.

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2. Scope

This document covers:

- Customer and opportunity qualification.
- Sales pipeline management in **Salesforce**.
- Pricing, promotions, discounts, and commercial approvals.
- Sales handover to Customer Operations, Finance, and Fulfilment.
- Key account and partner management.
- Performance reporting and required sales hygiene.
- Escalation of legal, financial, reputational, or customer-risk issues.

This playbook does not replace:

- Country-specific consumer protection or VAT requirements.
- The **Privacy and Data Handling Standard (LEG-PRV-002)**.
- Product safety, restricted goods, or marketplace operating procedures.
- Employment policies or compensation plans.

Where local law or an approved country policy is stricter than this playbook, the stricter requirement applies.

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3. Sales Operating Principles

IronStore sales activity is governed by the following principles:

- **Customer clarity:** Prices, delivery estimates, stock status, warranties, and return conditions must be accurate and understandable.
- **Profitable growth:** Revenue targets do not justify selling below approved margin, concealing fees, or making unsupported claims.
- **One source of truth:** Salesforce is the official record for managed opportunities, partner discussions, forecasts, and commercial approvals.
- **Evidence-based decisions:** Forecasts and proposals must use current pricing, stock, demand, and margin data.
- **Compliant communication:** Outreach must follow consent, opt-out, and country-specific direct-marketing rules.
- **Fast ownership:** Every active opportunity must have a named owner, next action, and due date.

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4. Standard Sales Procedure

4.1 Lead Capture and Assignment

Leads may originate from the website, inbound email, campaign landing pages, marketplaces, trade events, referrals, or approved outbound activity.

Sales Operations must:

- Create or synchronise the lead in Salesforce within **one business day**.
- Record source, country, language, product category, estimated value, and consent status.
- Check for duplicate accounts using email domain, company name, and VAT number where applicable.
- Route leads using the regional queue:
- **DACH:** Germany, Austria, Switzerland.
- **Benelux:** Belgium, Netherlands, Luxembourg.
- **France and Iberia:** France, Spain, Portugal.
- **Nordics and UK:** Denmark, Finland, Norway, Sweden, United Kingdom.
- Escalate unclear ownership to the Regional Sales Manager within one business day.

Leads containing payment details, identity documents, or sensitive personal information must not be stored in free-text Salesforce fields. Follow the Privacy and Data Handling Standard.

4.2 Qualification

The assigned representative must make an initial qualification attempt within:

- **Four business hours** for high-value partner or business enquiries.
- **One business day** for standard inbound enquiries.
- **Two business days** for campaign-generated leads.

Use the **BANT-E** framework:

- **Business need:** What product, category, or commercial problem is being addressed?
- **Authority:** Is the contact authorised to purchase or approve the proposal?
- **Need date:** When is delivery or campaign activation required?
- **Timing and budget:** Is there an approved budget or credible buying timeframe?
- **Evidence:** What information confirms the opportunity is genuine?

A qualified opportunity must include:

- Customer or partner profile.
- Estimated order value and currency.
- Expected close date.
- Product category and quantity, if known.
- Delivery market and fulfilment constraints.
- Decision-maker and next step.
- Qualification notes supported by customer communication.

Close or recycle a lead when it is duplicate, outside IronStore's operating markets, commercially unviable, or unresponsive after **three documented attempts over ten business days**.

4.3 Opportunity Stages

Salesforce opportunities use the following stages:

1. **New:** Lead accepted and ownership confirmed.
2. **Qualified:** Need, contact, market, and potential value recorded.
3. **Solution agreed:** Products, availability, delivery approach, and commercial terms discussed.
4. **Proposal sent:** Written quote or partner proposal issued.
5. **Commit:** Customer has confirmed intent, subject only to documented final conditions.
6. **Closed won/lost:** Order or agreement completed, or a reason for loss recorded.

Each opportunity must contain a current next action. Opportunities without a completed activity or future task for **14 days** are flagged in the weekly pipeline review.

A quote may not be marked **Commit** based only on verbal optimism. Evidence must include a purchase order, signed agreement, confirmed checkout path, or written customer commitment.

4.4 Proposals and Quotes

All commercial quotes must be generated from **Salesforce CPQ** or an approved country template. The quote must state:

- Product description, SKU, quantity, and availability status.
- Unit and total prices, currency, VAT treatment, and applicable fees.
- Delivery estimate and delivery location.
- Payment terms and quote expiry date.
- Return, warranty, and cancellation conditions where relevant.
- Named IronStore contact and escalation route.

Standard quote validity is **14 calendar days** unless stock, supplier pricing, or campaign terms require a shorter period.

Sales representatives must not promise guaranteed delivery dates unless confirmed by the **Order Management System (OMS)** and the relevant fulfilment team. “Available to order” must not be described as “in stock.”

4.5 Discount and Margin Controls

Discounts must protect the minimum contribution margin defined in the **Commercial Margin Matrix (FIN-COM-004)**.

Approval requirements:

- Up to **5%:** Sales representative, if within published campaign rules.
- Above 5% and up to **10%:** Regional Sales Manager.
- Above 10%, below floor margin, or with free delivery outside campaign rules: Director of Sales and Finance Business Partner.
- Any non-standard payment term, rebate, exclusivity, price guarantee, or marketing contribution: Commercial Director and Finance.
- Any commitment exceeding **€50,000** in gross order value: Director of Sales plus Finance approval.
- Commitments exceeding **€250,000**, exclusivity, or contractual liability require Executive Commercial Committee review.

Approvals must be attached to the Salesforce opportunity before the quote is sent. Backdated or undocumented discounts are prohibited.

Sales staff must not stack promotions unless the campaign rules explicitly permit it. Promotional codes intended for consumers must not be manually applied to business or partner orders without Commercial approval.

4.6 Order Handover

After customer acceptance, the sales owner must complete the **Sales-to-Operations Handover** in Salesforce within one business day.

The handover must include:

- Final quote or order reference.
- Confirmed SKUs, quantities, prices, VAT, and delivery address.
- Customer billing and contact details.
- Payment status or approved payment terms.
- Delivery deadline and any agreed service level.
- Open risks, substitutions, or customer dependencies.
- Relevant approval records and customer correspondence.

Operations validates the order in the OMS. Sales must not confirm final fulfilment until Operations accepts the handover.

If an order is delayed, partially unavailable, or materially different from the agreed terms, the sales owner must contact the customer within **one business day** of notification and document the resolution.

4.7 Account and Partner Management

Strategic accounts and partners are reviewed according to tier:

- **Tier 1:** More than €500,000 annual value or material strategic dependency; monthly review.
- **Tier 2:** €100,000–€499,999 annual value; quarterly review.
- **Tier 3:** Below €100,000 annual value; standard service and annual review.

Account plans must include:

- Revenue, margin, and order-frequency trends.
- Product categories and growth opportunities.
- Service issues, returns, and payment risks.
- Contract dates and renewal actions.
- Named stakeholders and relationship status.
- A documented plan for the next 90 days.

Partners must be assessed for brand, product compliance, data protection, payment, and reputational risk before onboarding. Marketplace or affiliate arrangements require review by Legal, Finance, and the relevant Channel Owner.

4.8 Forecasting and Pipeline Reviews

Salesforce forecasts are submitted by **12:00 CET each Monday**. Regional managers review:

- Pipeline coverage against monthly target.

- Stage ageing and stalled opportunities.
- Commit accuracy.
- Expected gross margin.
- Risks involving stock, delivery, payment, or approval.
- Lost opportunities and corrective actions.

The standard planning assumption is **3x pipeline coverage** against the remaining target, unless a regional plan specifies otherwise.

Forecast categories:

- **Commit:** High confidence; documented customer commitment.
- **Best case:** Credible opportunity with unresolved conditions.
- **Pipeline:** Qualified but not sufficiently advanced for the current forecast period.
- **Omitted:** Not expected to close in the forecast period.

Forecast manipulation, duplicate opportunities, inflated values, and artificial stage advancement are prohibited. Corrections must be made before the weekly review.

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5. Customer Communication and Conduct

Sales representatives must:

- Use approved IronStore email signatures and country-language templates.
- Identify IronStore clearly in outbound communications.
- Honour unsubscribe and do-not-contact requests immediately.
- Avoid claims about product performance, sustainability, availability, or savings unless supported by approved product or campaign information.
- Use the customer’s preferred language where reasonably possible.
- Record material commitments in Salesforce.

Do not request or retain full payment-card details, account passwords, government identification, or unnecessary health information. Direct payment issues to the secure checkout or Finance process.

Potential fraud indicators include mismatched billing and delivery details, unusual urgency, repeated failed payments, requests to redirect goods, or pressure to bypass standard approval. Escalate suspected fraud to **Fraud Operations** and do not accuse the customer or continue informal negotiation.

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6. Roles and Responsibilities

- **Sales Representative:** Owns lead follow-up, qualification, communication, opportunity accuracy, and handover.

- **Regional Sales Manager:** Approves delegated discounts, manages pipeline quality, coaches representatives, and resolves ownership issues.
- **Sales Operations:** Maintains Salesforce, routing rules, dashboards, templates, and playbook training.
- **Commercial Director:** Approves non-standard commercial structures and major strategic commitments.
- **Finance Business Partner:** Validates margin, payment terms, credit exposure, rebates, and forecast quality.
- **Merchandising and Supply Chain:** Confirm assortment, stock, supplier constraints, and delivery feasibility.
- **Customer Operations:** Owns post-order service, returns, complaints, and customer-impacting fulfilment updates.
- **Legal and Compliance:** Advises on contracts, privacy, consumer law, claims, and regulatory escalation.

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7. Related Documents and References

- **FIN-COM-004 — Commercial Margin Matrix**
- **SAL-OPS-003 — Salesforce Data Quality Standard**
- **SAL-OPS-006 — Sales-to-Operations Handover**
- **MKT-DIR-001 — Direct Marketing and Consent Standard**
- **LEG-PRV-002 — Privacy and Data Handling Standard**
- **OPS-FUL-005 — Order and Fulfilment Exceptions**
- **FIN-CRE-002 — Credit, Payment Terms, and Collections**
- **COM-PRD-007 — Product Claims and Promotional Copy Approval**
- Salesforce, Salesforce CPQ, OMS, and Power BI sales dashboards

Questions about this playbook should be directed to **Sales Operations** through the IronStore Service Desk under category **Commercial Policy**.

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8. Revision History

- **August 2026 — Version 3.0:** Added BANT-E qualification, revised discount approval thresholds, introduced tiered partner reviews, and clarified OMS handover controls.
- **November 2025 — Version 2.2:** Updated Salesforce stage definitions, forecast categories, and lead response timeframes.
- **May 2025 — Version 2.0:** Consolidated regional sales guidance and introduced the Commercial Margin Matrix reference.